continues down the middleware pipeline. As no endpoint is selected, the `EndpointMiddleware` silently ignores the request and passes it to the next middleware in the pipeline. The `EndpointMiddleware` is typically the final middleware in the pipeline, so the "next" middleware is normally the dummy middleware that always returns a `404 Not Found` response, as you saw in chapter 4.

TIP If the request URL doesn't match a route template, no endpoint is selected or executed. The whole middleware pipeline is still executed, but typically a `404` response is returned when the request reaches the dummy `404` middleware.

The advantage of having two separate pieces of middleware to handle this process may not be obvious at first blush. Figure 6.3 hinted at the main benefit: all middleware placed after the `RoutingMiddleware` can see which endpoint is *going* to be executed before it is.

NOTE Only middleware placed after the `RoutingMiddleware` can detect which endpoint is going to be executed.

Figure 6.4 shows a more realistic middleware pipeline in which middleware is placed both *before* the `RoutingMiddleware` and *between* the `RoutingMiddleware` and the `EndpointMiddleware`.